

Wonderstorm Academy — Photography Shot List

For Brittany · Saturday 5 September 2026, 1pm · the school is EMPTY (closed until Sept 8)

The brief in one line

The website currently sells a learner-driven school using stock photography of teacher-fronted classrooms. Saturday replaces the **place**: the building and every room inside it, shot so the site shows Wonderstorm and not a placeholder. The **people** frames (children working, leading, resolving) come on a school day after Sept 8, with releases signed first.

Technical specs

Spec	Value	Why
Orientation	Landscape for everything except portraits	Every crop on the site is landscape
Crops the site uses	21:9, 16:9, 3:2, 4:3, and 1:1	Shoot wide and loose so all five can be cut from one frame
Hero frames	Subject right of centre , quiet space on the left third	A dark gradient and white headline sit over the left side
Resolution	Largest your camera offers, RAW + JPEG	Some frames run full-bleed at 2x on retina
Files	Deliver flat, original filenames	Renaming happens on our side

Shoot every setup wide. A tight frame can be cropped out of a wide one; the reverse is not true.

Priority 1 — THE ROOMS (the whole afternoon is this)

Jack after walking the building: "complete freedom in there for the children, and it's very stimulating. All the rooms are different." That sentence is the website. A room-by-room walkthrough is something no competitor can copy.

Shoot every distinct room the same way:

Height	Same eye height every time — standing adult, consistent
Lens	One focal length for the whole set. Do not zoom between rooms
Angle	From the doorway or a corner, showing the <i>whole</i> room

Frames per room	Two: one as found, one staged (materials out, a project mid-way, chairs pulled in)
Order	Shoot in the order you'd walk them, and note that order

Count the rooms first, then shoot all of them. Holly hosts an event Friday night and warned the place may be "a mess" — staging each room is a five-minute pickup with her, not a problem. A little mess reads as a school in use.

Priority 2 — the four frames the site has nothing for

1. The building, arriving. *(for /visit and the homepage)*

Late light. From the street or car park, the **Wonderstorm Academy sign legible** in frame. Landscape, wide. If Holly or Dave will walk toward the door, seen from behind, better. → *The single most valuable frame of the day.*

2. The lab where a student would lead. *(for /platform)*

The room set for a session: a stool or standing spot at the front, the circle of seats around it, the adult's chair off to the side. Empty, but staged so the arrangement tells the story.

3. An expedition table. *(for /atlas)*

Materials out, a half-built project, tools, notes, mess. No hands needed.

4. The S.O.S. corner. *(for /calibration)*

Wherever conflict gets worked out — the peace table, two chairs facing, a rug and a talking object. Ask Holly which spot that is.

Priority 3 — the rest of the building

5. **The entrance and the threshold** — door, sign, the first thing a family sees.

6. **Reading corner / quiet space** — beanbags, window light. *(/los)*

7. **Screens and desks** — where the portal gets used. *(/los, /portal)*

8. **The four labs side by side** — each age band's room, same angle. *(/studios)*

9. **Making space** — tools, materials, prototypes, a workbench. *(/method, /learning)*

10. **Where work gets shown** — the wall or shelf of finished work. *(/apply, /atlas)*

11. **Outdoors** — garden, yard, anything green. *(/atlas Food Forest, Living Waters)*

Priority 4 — people and details

12. **Holly, in the building.** Not a headshot — in a room, mid-movement, warm.

13. **Dave, the same,** if he's there.

14. **Holly and Dave together**, if they will sit for it.

15. **Details** — student work on walls, a hand-written board, materials on a shelf, the emblem on a door, the schedule. Shoot twenty; they fill gaps for years.

What NOT to shoot

- **Any other school's or company's signage in frame.** One current photo has "microSchool" on the wall.

- **Rows of desks facing a whiteboard.** Even empty, it reads as a lecture room and contradicts the pitch. If a room is set that way, restage it.

- **Anything with children.** None are expected Saturday; if any are present, no faces until releases are signed.

Next shoot (school day, after Sept 8, releases signed)

A student leading with the adult off to the side · an expedition mid-mess · children resolving something with no adult in frame · Open Circle · mixed ages.